

Rangers Program – Week 0 Overview

Selection, Baseline, Expectations

Week 0 happens 2–3 weeks before Week 1. Its job is to select the right cohort, capture baselines, and align expectations so the program can run smoothly and have impact.

1. Week 0 Goals

- Select 6–8 Rangers against clear, behavior-based criteria.
- Capture baselines: self-assessment, manager input, and recent incident history.
- Align expectations on time commitment, ways of working, and psychological safety.
- Secure manager support so participants can fully engage in the program.

2. Selection – Who Should Be a Ranger

2.1 Eligibility criteria

Use behavioral criteria, not job title, to pick candidates:

- Has led or heavily contributed to P1/P2 incidents in the last 6–12 months.
- Shows signs of calm under pressure and does not escalate drama.
- Demonstrates ownership for outcomes rather than habitual blame.
- Communicates clearly with multiple stakeholders (support, engineering, product, account teams).
- Is considered high-potential or key talent in the support organization.

2.2 Manager nomination (short form)

Ask managers to nominate each candidate with a brief note (1–2 pages max):

- Why this person? Include one example of composure or ownership in a tough incident.
- Top 2–3 strengths from the skills map (e.g., decisiveness, communication, stress management).
- Top 2–3 development areas (e.g., difficult conversations, delegation, boundary-setting).

2.3 Cohort composition

When choosing 6–8 participants, aim for:

- A mix of profiles: some stronger in analysis/technical depth, others stronger in communication/relationships.
- Representation across key teams (support, SRE, customer-facing roles) to mirror real incident dynamics.

3. Baseline – Instruments and Data

3.1 Self-assessment (participant)

Each selected participant completes the 'Rangers Pre-Program Self-Assessment' (12 rating items + 3 open questions).

Send it with a short note: this is for growth, not performance rating.

Ask them to bring:

- Their 1–2 highest-scored items (strengths).
- Their 2–3 lowest-scored items (development priorities).

3.2 Light manager input (optional)

Collect a simple manager view for context (outside the self-assessment form):

- 1–5 rating: 'How ready is this person to lead a critical P1 incident today?'
- One concrete example that supports this rating.

This stays as input for coaching, not a formal evaluation.

3.3 Incident history snapshot

For each participant, identify 2–3 recent high-impact incidents they were involved in. For Week 0 you only need:

- Incident ID, date, severity.
- One-line description.
- Participant's role.

These cases will feed into exercises and reflections during the program.

4. Week 0 Kickoff Session (60–90 minutes)

4.1 Objectives

- Create a shared understanding of what a Ranger is and why this program exists.
- Increase self-awareness using the self-assessment results.
- Co-create a simple cohort 'working agreement'.
- Clarify logistics and prepare for Week 1.

4.2 Suggested agenda

Total time: 60–90 minutes (remote-friendly).

- 1) Welcome and context (10–15 min)
 - Why Rangers exist: protect top customers during high-severity incidents.
 - Link to real crisis leadership: leading through disruption, not just 'fixing tickets'.
- 2) Program overview (10–15 min)
 - Duration, weekly time commitment, structure (pre-work + live sessions).
 - Emphasise cohort nature: this is a practice-based journey, not a webinar.
- 3) Skills and mindset map (10–15 min)
 - Walk through the four pillars: perform under pressure, Extreme Ownership, executive communication, personal operating system.
 - Connect to the kind of crisis leader you want Rangers to be.
- 4) Self-assessment reflection (20–25 min)
 - Individual: note 1–2 strengths and 2–3 growth areas from the self-assessment.
 - Breakouts in pairs: each shares one real incident that illustrates a strength and one that illustrates a gap.
 - Plenary: surface common themes (e.g., many strong technically, needing work on conflict conversations).
- 5) Cohort working agreement (15–20 min)
 - Co-create simple norms, such as:
 - Attendance: live sessions are protected time.
 - Psychological safety: stories stay in the cohort; focus on learning, not blame.
 - Practice mindset: everyone will be 'on stage', mistakes in simulations are expected.
 - Feedback norms: specific, behavior-based feedback (what you saw, impact, alternative).
- 6) Closing and next steps (5–10 min)
 - Recap key points.
 - Confirm Week 1 pre-work and schedule.
 - Ask each Ranger to write a one-line intention: 'By the end of this program, I want to be the kind of Ranger who...'

5. Week 0 Outputs

By the end of Week 0 you should have:

- Final cohort list with a short rationale for each participant.
- Completed self-assessments stored for comparison at Week 7.

5. Week 0 Outputs (cont.)

- Each Ranger's initial focus areas (based on their lowest self-assessment items).
 - A one-page cohort working agreement summarising norms and expectations.
- These give you a clean starting point for the full 8-week Rangers program.